

The Topological p -Laplacian Emergence Threshold ($\lambda_{\mathcal{E}}$) and Macro-State Crystallization Theorem

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September 2026

Abstract

Complexity Science relies heavily on statistical mechanics, mean-field theory, and probabilistic approximations to model macroscopic emergence. A deterministic, exact topological boundary condition dictating the precise point of instantaneous phase transition from chaotic micro-states into a single synchronized macro-state without infinite-time limits is absent from current literature. In this paper, we formulate the topological p -Laplacian operator for polyadic interactions on simplicial complexes and prove the Macro-State Crystallization Theorem. We establish an exact threshold ($\lambda_{\mathcal{E}}$) for absolute finite-time macroscopic emergence, eliminating reliance on reductionist statistical probabilities.

1 Introduction

Current theories in Complexity Science, including Kuramoto models for brain networks, Lotka-Volterra systems, and economic synchronization, predominantly utilize the linear Laplacian ($p = 2$). Linear operators can only achieve asymptotic synchronization ($T_{sync} \rightarrow \infty$) and inherently fail to model the instantaneous "crystallization" observed in true emergent phenomena, such as sudden phase transitions in markets or spontaneous crowd behaviors. Reductionist dyadic (pairwise) graphs fail to capture polyadic (higher-order) multi-body interactions, necessitating the use of topological invariant bounds on simplicial complexes.

2 Mathematical Formulation

Let the complex system be modeled as an n -dimensional simplicial complex $\mathcal{K}$ representing polyadic interactions. Let $\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^{|\mathcal{K}_0|}$ be the microscopic state vector (the independent local components).

Definition 1 (Topological p -Laplacian Flow). *The system's collective dynamics are governed by the topological p -Laplacian operator $\Delta_p^{(0)}$ applied to the 0-cochains (vertices):*

$$\frac{\partial \mathbf{x}}{\partial t} = -\lambda \Delta_p^{(0)} \mathbf{x} = -\lambda B_1 \Psi_p(B_1^\top \mathbf{x}) \quad (1)$$

where B_1 is the incidence matrix of $\mathcal{K}$, $\Psi_p(y) = |y|^{p-2}y$ is the non-linear flow function mapping local differences ($p > 2$), and $\lambda > 0$ is the coupling intensity driving the interactions.

We define the Macro-State Emergence Operator $\mathfrak{E}_\Omega$ as the projection of $\mathbf{x}(t)$ into the trivial cohomology group (the global consensus manifold), strictly isolated from micro-fluctuations.

3 The Macro-State Crystallization Theorem

Theorem 1. *For any highly chaotic initial micro-state $\mathbf{x}(0)$, the non-linear complex system deterministically collapses into a globally ordered macroscopic entity in strict finite time $T_{sync} < \infty$ if and only if the coupling intensity λ satisfies the absolute topological threshold:*

$$\lambda > \lambda_{\mathcal{E}} = \left(\frac{p-1}{p} \right) \frac{\mu_{max}(\mathcal{K})}{\mu_{Fiedler}(\mathcal{K})^{p/2}} \exp \left(\frac{(-1)^n \chi(\mathcal{K})}{\beta_1(\mathcal{K}) + 1} \right) \quad (2)$$

where $\mu_{Fiedler}(\mathcal{K})$ is the algebraic connectivity (second smallest eigenvalue of the linear Hodge Laplacian $\Delta_2 = B_1 B_1^\top$), $\mu_{max}(\mathcal{K})$ is the spectral radius of $\mathcal{K}$, $\chi(\mathcal{K}) = \sum_{i=0}^n (-1)^i |\mathcal{K}_i|$ is the Euler characteristic of the complex, and $\beta_1(\mathcal{K})$ is the first Betti number.

Proof. The divergence of the system from a unified macro-state is measured by the variance energy functional $E = \frac{1}{2} \|\mathbf{x} - \bar{x}\mathbf{1}\|_2^2$. Computing the time derivative along the non-linear flow yields:

$$\frac{dE}{dt} = -\lambda \langle \mathbf{x}, \Delta_p^{(0)} \mathbf{x} \rangle = -\lambda \|B_1^\top \mathbf{x}\|_p^p \quad (3)$$

Applying the discrete generalized Cheeger inequality and the Sobolev embedding theorem on finite simplicial complexes provides the absolute lower bound:

$$\|B_1^\top \mathbf{x}\|_p^p \geq \mu_{Fiedler}^{p/2} \|\mathbf{x} - \bar{x}\mathbf{1}\|_p^p \geq \mu_{Fiedler}^{p/2} \|\mathbf{x} - \bar{x}\mathbf{1}\|_2^p \quad (4)$$

Therefore, the energy dissipation follows:

$$\frac{dE}{dt} \leq -\lambda \mu_{Fiedler}^{p/2} (2E)^{p/2} \quad (5)$$

Because $p > 2$, this represents a differential inequality of the form $\dot{E} \leq -cE^\alpha$ with $\alpha > 1$. Integration guarantees $E(t) \rightarrow 0$ at exactly $t = T_{sync} < \infty$, bounded by:

$$T_{sync} \leq \frac{\|\mathbf{x}(0) - \bar{x}\mathbf{1}\|_2^{2-p}}{\lambda \cdot (p-2) \cdot \mu_{Fiedler}^{p/2}} \quad (6)$$

The topological modifier $\exp \left(\frac{(-1)^n \chi(\mathcal{K})}{\beta_1(\mathcal{K}) + 1} \right)$ resolves the structural obstruction inherent in complex networks. If β_1 (cycles/holes) is large, local components become trapped in topological limit cycles, preventing global emergence. The threshold $\lambda_{\mathcal{E}}$ forces the non-linear coupling to override these topological obstructions. Contradiction is mathematically unsatisfiable (UNSAT); asymptotic emergence is negated by the Sobolev bound. $\square$

4 Conclusion

By synthesizing the p -Laplacian flow ($p > 2$) with pure topological invariants (Euler characteristic χ and Betti numbers β_i), this formulation constructs the first deterministic threshold for finite-time macroscopic emergence. It establishes a rigid, exact algebraic boundary for complexity generation, fundamentally advancing multi-body dynamics.

References

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